RUBEN R SALAS

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. University of Pennsylvania *2023 - Current*
The Wharton School
Operations, Information, and Decisions

M.A. University of Pennsylvania *2023 - 2025*
The Wharton School
Dual Master of Arts in Statistics and Data Science

MBA INCAE Business School *2020*
Master in Business Administration
High Honors

M.S. Costa Rica National University *2016*
Master in Management Information Systems (MIS)
IT Project Management concentration

B.S. Costa Rica Distance State University *2014*
Business Administration & Finance
Valedictorian

B.S. Costa Rica National University *2010*
Systems Engineering

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Broad Interests: Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Quantitative Marketing, Information Systems.

Methodological Interests: Experimental Design, Mechanistic Interpretability of LLMs, Gradient-Based Methods, Bayesian Inference, Generative AI.

Applications: Generative Engine Optimization, Agentic Commerce, Human–AI Collaboration, AI and Creativity.

WORKING PAPERS

- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K., "Stranger Names: Measuring Brand Distinctiveness with Language Models" (2026).
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K., "Tell Me the Truth: Conjoint Analysis in the LLMs Era" (2026).
  - Accepted at INFORMS Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST 2026).
  - Accepted at Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE 2026).
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar K. , "AI-Mediated Marketing: Constrained Content Optimization for LLM Visibility" (2025)
  - **Dominique Hanssens Best PhD Paper Award** ($5,000), Artificial Intelligence in Management (AIM) Conference, USC Marshall, 2026.
  - Presented at Workshop on Information Technology and Systems (WITS 2025).
  - Presented at Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE 2025).

- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar K., "Beyond Fluency: A Process–Centric Analysis of Human–AI Collaboration in Creative Industries" (2025).
  - **Best Paper Award** INFORMS Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST).
  - **Best PhD Paper Award** ($5,000), Artificial Intelligence in Management (AIM) Conference, USC Marshall.
- Ramirez-Salas, R. & Fernandez-Corrales, C. (2022, September) "Does a CDO enhance Company Inventiveness? An Empirical Study on New Managerial Positions and Innovation ".

CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS, BOOK CHAPTERS, AND OTHER WRITING

- Invited Panelist, Academy of Management Annual Meeting (AOM 2026), Philadelphia, PA.
- Invited Panelist, INFORMS Annual Meeting (INFORMS 2026), San Francisco, CA.
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K. (2026, December). "Tell Me the Truth: Conjoint Analysis in the LLMs Era" [Paper presentation], Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE 2026), Lisbon, Portugal.
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K. (2026, October). "Tell Me the Truth: Conjoint Analysis in the LLMs Era" [Paper presentation], INFORMS Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST 2026), San Francisco, CA.
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K. (2026, March). "AI-Mediated Marketing: Constrained Content Optimization for LLM Visibility" [Paper presentation], Artificial Intelligence in Management (AIM 2026), University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA. Recipient of the **Dominique Hanssens Best PhD Paper Award** ($5,000).
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K. (2025, October). "Beyond Fluency: A Process–Centric Analysis of Human–AI Collaboration in Creative Industries" [Paper presentation], INFORMS Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST), Atlanta, GA. Recipient of the **Best Paper Award**.
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K. (2025, March). "Beyond Fluency: A Process–Centric Analysis of Human–AI Collaboration in Creative Industries" [Paper presentation], Artificial Intelligence in Management (AIM 2025), University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA. Recipient of the **Vithala Rao Best PhD Paper Award** ($5,000).
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K. (2025, December) "AI-Mediated Marketing: Constrained Content Optimization for LLM Visibility" [Paper presentation], Workshop on Information Technology and Systems (WITS 2025), Nashville, TN.
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K. (2025, December) "AI-Mediated Marketing: Constrained Content Optimization for LLM Visibility" [Paper presentation], Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE 2025), Nashville, TN.
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K. (2024, December) "Artificial Intelligence Sense of Humor and its Economic Effects for Creative Industries" [Paper presentation], Discussant: Jonathan Hersh. Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE 2024), Bangkok, Thailand.
- R Salas, R. & Hosanagar, K. (2024, December) "Artificial Intelligence Sense of Humor and its Economic Effects for Creative Industries" [Paper presentation], Yale Conference on Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, and Business Analytics, Connecticut, US.
- Ramirez-Salas, R. & Fernandez-Corrales, C. (2022, September) "Does a CDO enhance Company Inventiveness? An Empirical Study on new Managerial Positions and Innovation " [Paper presentation]. Strategic Management Society (SMS) 42nd Annual Conference, London, UK.
- Ramirez-Salas, R. & Fernandez-Corrales, C. (2022, August) "Does a CDO enhance Company Inventiveness? An Empirical Study on new Managerial Positions and Innovation " [Paper presentation]. Twenty-eighth Americas Conference on Information Systems (AMCIS), Minneapolis, MN. (awarded)

GRANTS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

- **Winkelman Fellowship in Applied Economics**, The Wharton School, 2026. A highly prestigious doctoral fellowship awarded to the Wharton PhD student (across all departments) who has demonstrated to the school's faculty great promise for an outstanding research and teaching career at the world's leading schools of management.
- INFORMS Best conference paper award (CIST 2025)
- Stavros Niarchos Foundation Paideia Graduate Fellow, 2025–2026. Selected to lead initiatives advancing civic dialogue and student engagement through the PIT (Public Interest Technology) program.
- Marjorie Weiler Prize for Excellence in Writing, The Wharton School, 2025. Recognizes exceptional clarity, coherence, and critical thinking in doctoral writing.
- Dominique Hanssens Best PhD Paper Award ($5,000), Artificial Intelligence in Management (AIM) Conference, University of Southern California, USC, 2026.
- Vithala Rao Best PhD Paper Award ($5,000), Artificial Intelligence in Management (AIM) Conference, University of Southern California, USC, 2025.
- Analytics at Wharton, Spring Grant 2025.
- Analytics at Wharton, Spring Grant 2024.
- George Logan Fund. Support young member(s) of faculty with the most promising research agenda. 2022.
- Americas Conference on Information Systems (AMCIS 2020). Selected among top papers (AMCIS2022), Minneapolis, 2022

MEDIA APPEARANCES

- "Wharton's AI Doctors Are In," *Wharton Magazine*, Spring/Summer 2026. [Link]
- "Penn Public Interest Technology initiative hosts virtual fireside talk on AI applications," *The Daily Pennsylvanian*, December 2025. [Link]

PEER REVIEW AND SERVICE ACTIVITIES

- Reviewer, *Management Information Systems Quarterly* (MISQ)
- Reviewer, *International Conference on Information Systems* (ICIS), 2026
- Reviewer, *Workshop on Information Technology and Systems* (WITS), 2026
- PhD Mentor for incoming doctoral students, The Wharton School, 2026.
- Guest Expert on AI for Small Business, Penn-CCP Entrepreneurship Academy (University of Pennsylvania and Community College of Philadelphia), inaugural cohort, Fall 2026.

TEACHING

The Wharton School

- Wharton Doctoral Tech Camp (PhD), Summer 2026.
- Wharton Doctoral Tech Camp (PhD), Summer 2025.
- Carpentries Ecology programming workshop, UPenn CURF (Undergrad), June 2025.
- Wharton Doctoral Tech Camp (PhD), Summer 2024.
- Carpentries Ecology programming workshop, UPenn CURF (Undergrad), June 2024.
- Carpentries Social Science programming workshop, UPenn Library (Undergrad), March 2024.

INCAE Business School

- AI and Technology for Senior Executives (Executive), Panama City, October 2026.
- AI and Technology for Senior Executives (Executive), Guatemala City, August 2026.
- AI for Business (Executive MBA), 2025.
- Marketing Technology (Executive MBA), online in partnership with Emeritus, 2022.
- Quantitative Methods (Master's), MAIT, 2021.
- CS50 (Computer Science) for Business (Master's), MAIT, 2021.

OTHER EXPERIENCE

- AI Scientist, Bodhium Labs, Menlo Park, CA (Summer 2026). Building AI models that bring quantitative research into commercial applications and products.
- Research Assistant to Avi Goldfarb, Rotman School of Management (Fall 2022)
- Pre-doctoral researcher, INCAE Business School (2021-2022)

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

- Information Technology Center of Excellence Team Leader, CPG industry (2012-2019)
- Business Intelligence Developer, Banking Sector (2011 - 2012)
- Information Technology Consultant, Manufacturing sector (2010 - 2011).

ADDITIONAL

Tech Skills	Probabilistic Machine Learning, Python, R, LLMs
Databases	SQL, MongoDB
Professional Certifications	PMP, ITILv4, ISO/IEC 27001
Hobbies	Chess player